

Ancient History





About the Course

Read about ancient history from 100 BC-350 AD through biographies, primary source documents, historical fiction, and history spines. Students will view images, reference maps, and update their Book of Centuries as part of the lessons.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.), History: Grades 7-8 (Canada), History: Grade 9 (U.S.), History: Grade 9 (Canada)



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-9	Ancient History: Grades 7-9 1 time/week 30 min	The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church A Short History of Ancient Rome

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)				
	World History: Grades 7-8 U.S. History: Grades 7-8		Ancient History: Grades 7-9 U.S. History: Grades 7-8	
History: Grades 7-8 (Canada)				
	World History: Grades 7-8 Canadian History: Grades 7-8		Ancient History: Grades 7-9 Canadian History: Grades 7-8	
History: Grade 9 (U.S.)				
U.S. History: Grades 9-12	U.S. History: Grades 9-12	Ancient History: Grades 7-9	World History: Grade 9	
History: Grade 9 (Canada)				
Canadian History: Grades 9-10	Canadian History: Grades 9-10	Ancient History: Grades 7-9	World History: Grade 9	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

The Sand-Reckoner is a well-written and well-researched account of a portion of the life of Archimedes. Math, engineering, duty, justice, stewardship, and courage are some of the themes. The setting is Syracuse in 264 B.C. and as such has a few references to immoral behavior representative of the period as well as some light romantic content that you may

want to preview to decide what is best for your particular student(s), especially those on the younger end of the age range. Some may choose to read the story aloud to edit on the fly if needed and to encourage discussion. Some may choose to edit some wording in the text. Others will be fine with the content as is. We encourage all to provide an inviting space for students to ask questions and share thoughts as they process what they are reading in their books. Pages to preview: 14, 36, 40-41, 171, 198, 204, 249. There is always the option of substituting for either of the books scheduled in Grades 4-6 as well.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Ancient History: Grades 7-9



The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church



A Short History of Ancient Rome



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



Ancient History: Grades 7-9

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any necessary links.
- If you have not read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.
- Decide which lessons/books to read together and which to have students read independently.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Have students give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If the previous passage is difficult to remember, teachers may ask a leading question: "What can you tell me about..." Or students may try looking back at any chapter/section headings or illustrations or reading the first paragraph to jog the memory.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson (often included in lesson plans).
- If necessary, talk about a few unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud or have the student read independently. Sometimes reading for the specified time is a better guide.
- If a book is challenging, try stopping to narrate every now and then rather than waiting until the end. It can also help to read aloud. Or you might want to use an audiobook version of the text and have students read along with it.
- Have students keep an eye out for events or characters to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, or Copywork Book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or write a narration.
- Alternatively, students might analyze a character, trace cause to consequence, outline a passage, or use one of the other methods indicated by Charlotte Mason in School Education Chapter 16, especially p.180.
- Students who enjoy writing can experiment with different types of written narrations, but this is not required.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made (orally or in writing).
- You could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question to stimulate discussion. Discussion questions are often included in the lesson plans.



Connect

- Optional: Add something to the Book of Centuries, Century Chart, Citizenship Notebook, or Commonplace book. If students would like to include pictures, these may be drawn or printed.

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 1

WEEK 1

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 1

Meeting Sulla

 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

"Rome wasn't built in a day" maybe a proverb that you are familiar with. And it is true. Rome was founded in 509 B.C and from it's founding passed from any leaders and participated in many wars. As Rome and its leaders conquered people groups, many groups assimilated to life among the culture. Political leaders arose and fell and the Roman republic found itself under threat from outside forces and from within.

Leaders who were elected into positions within the Roman republic also found themselves under constant threat. Sulla, who will be introduced in this chapter, is one such man. He finds outside forces plotting against him and marshals an army to face his opponent. Sulla will be only one of the many leaders of Rome that you will read about in Pascal Hughes' A Short History of Ancient Rome.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.89-99 - end at "political violence tamed"

→ LOCATE

In your Historical Atlas of the World, turn to p. 14-15 and locate the various locations that you can find in your readings.

WEEK 2

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 2

Meeting Sulla Continued...

 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading on Sulla?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.99-107 - start at "the Coming Men"

- What in the chapter was surprising to you?

→ LOCATE

In your Historical Atlas of the World, turn to p. 14-15 and locate the various locations that you can find in your readings

WEEK 3

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 3

Spartacus and a Revolt

 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

One horrific reality of the ancient world is slavery. While nations changed leaders, it caused internal havoc which included revolutions led by many different groups. One such group would be slaves who rose up in a revolt led by Spartacus.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.110-118 - stop at "Third Servile War"

- How did Spartacus' actions influence the Roman Empire?

→ LOCATE

In your Historical Atlas of the World, turn to p. 14-15 and locate the various locations that you can find in your readings

WEEK 4

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 4

The Beginning of a Legend

 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Think on what've read about Spartacus in the past.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.118-126 - start at "To Vesuvius"

→ LOCATE

In your Historical Atlas of the World, turn to p. 14-15 and locate the various locations that you can find in your readings

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 1

WEEK 5

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 5

Introducing Caesar

 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome

→ INTRO

Julius Caesar is the most famous leader of the Roman Republic. Famous for his life and famous for his death which inspire, music, plays and modern day television. As you read through the story retold by Pascal Hughes, consider the many reasons for it's importance.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.128-137 - stop at "even bigger one"

- Why is Julius Caesar's story so infamous?

→ LOCATE

In your Historical Atlas of the World, turn to p. 14-15 and locate the various locations that you can find in your readings.

WEEK 6

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 6

Caesar's Antics

 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome

→ RECAP

What did you learn about Caesar in last weeks reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.137-152 - start at "Triumvirate"

- What was the most interesting thing in this weeks reading?

→ LOCATE

In your Historical Atlas of the World, turn to p. 14-15 and locate the various locations that you can find in your readings.

WEEK 7

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 7

Introducing Octavian

 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome

→ INTRO

With Julius Caesar's death, came the question of who would succeed him? That position would fall upon Octavian. But it would not be easy to assume the position as others would be looking to take his place.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.154-164 - end at "of the Roman World"

- What was the most interesting thing in this weeks reading?

→ LOCATE

In your Historical Atlas of the World, turn to p.14-15 and locate the various locations that you can find in your readings.

WEEK 8

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 8

Antony and Cleopatra

 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome

→ RECAP

Think about last week's reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.164-172 - start at "Antony and Cleopatra"

- There is much debate in the historical community as to the reasons the Roman Republic fell. What do you think contributed to the fall of the Roman Empire?

→ LOCATE

In your Historical Atlas of the World, turn to p. 14-15 and locate the various locations that you can find in your readings.

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 1		
WEEK 9	30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 9 Nero Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → INTRO The Emperor Nero is another famous ruler, but his notoriety comes from the evil that he did as Emperor of Rome. Nero was most known for his murder of anyone who opposed or threatened him. And as Jesus' popularity had increased and his teachings had spread, Nero picked out a new target for his ire: the Christians. Martyrdom under Nero would become infamously horrendous. But it is from these stories of men and women who died for Christ. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.174-182 - stop at "ruler and ruled" → LOCATE In your Historical Atlas of the World, turn to p. 14-15 and locate the various locations that you can find in your readings.	TEACHER TIP This chapter may have sensitive content.
WEEK 10	30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 10 Nero Continued... Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → RECAP Think back to last week's reading. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.182-191 - start at "Schism" → LOCATE In your Historical Atlas of the World, turn to p. 14-15 and locate the various locations that you can find in your readings.	
WEEK 11	30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 11 → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 12	30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 12 → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: A Short History of Ancient Rome	

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 2

WEEK 1	 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 13 <i>Boudica</i> Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → INTRO The Roman Empire has a problem with uprisings. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.194-200 - end at "list of concerns" → LOCATE In your Historical Atlas of the World, turn to p. 14-15 and locate the various locations that you can find in your readings.	Boudica's story is full of peril and
WEEK 2	 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 14 <i>Boudica</i> Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.201-211 - start at "Trouble Brewing"	
WEEK 3	 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 15 <i>Julia Felix</i> Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.214-223 - end at "Pliny"	
WEEK 4	 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 16 <i>Julia Felix</i> Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.223-227 - start at "Pliny"	
WEEK 5	 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 17 <i>Trajan</i> Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.231-239 - end at "The Peerless Roman Military"	
WEEK 6	 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 18 <i>Trajan</i> Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.239-246 - start at "The Peerless Roman Military"	
WEEK 7	 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 19 <i>Colosseum</i> Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch. 14	

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 2	
WEEK 8 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 20 Severus Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.262-270 stop at "A Year of the Five Emperors"	
WEEK 9 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 21 Severus Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.270-278 start at "A Year of the Five Emperors"	
WEEK 10 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 22 Zenobia and Decline Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.278-291 stop at "Out of the Shadows"	
WEEK 11 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 23 Zenobia and Decline Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.291-210 start at "Out of the Shadows"	
WEEK 12 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 24 → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: A Short History of Ancient Rome	

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 3

WEEK 1

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 25

Meeting Women in the Early Church

 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
P. 13-26

WEEK 2

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 26

Meeting Women in the Early Church

 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
P. 27-35 stop at "The Women Who Bankrolled the Ministry"

WEEK 3

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 27

Meeting Women in the Early Church

 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
P. 35-46 start at "The Women Who Bankrolled the Ministry" stop at "St. Thecla"

WEEK 4

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 28

Thecla

 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
P. 46-60 start at "St. Thecla" stop at "St. Perpetua and St. Felicity"

WEEK 5

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 29

Perpetua and Felicity

 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
P. 60-67 start at "St. Perpetua and St. Felicity" stop at "St. Blandina"

WEEK 6

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 30

St. Blandina

 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
P. 67-73 start at "St. Blandina" end at "St. Agnes of Rome"

WEEK 7

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 31

St. Agnes

 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
P. 73-80 start at "St. Agnes of Rome" and end at "Prudentius"

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 3

WEEK 8

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 32

St. Agnes Continued...

 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ **INTRO**

Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

P. 80-87 start at "Prudentius"

WEEK 9

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 33

The Poets and Thinkers

 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ **INTRO**

Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

P. 89-101 end at "St. Marcella"

WEEK 10

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 34

Marcella and Paula

 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ **INTRO**

Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

P. 101-120 start at "St. Marcella"

WEEK 11

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 35

St. Monica

 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ **INTRO**

Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

P. 121-132 start at "St. Monica"

WEEK 12

30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 36

→ EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: *The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church*